

EXAMINED

Belkin Kakao Friends Edition Boost Up 10W wireless charger

Belkin launched a new 10W wireless charger in India in collaboration with Kakao Friends, animated characters based on Korea's KakaoTalk emoticons. We received the white-coloured variant with the character Apeach on it. The black variant, on the other hand, has the character Ryan on it. Now, coming to the charger itself, the Belkin Kakao Friends Edition Boost Up is a speedy 10W Qi wireless charger that can charge any Qi-enabled device such as smartphones or even true wireless earphones such as the Samsung Galaxy Buds Plus. Priced at ₹3,499 the charger offers 7.5W wireless charging for iPhones, and 9W wireless charging for Samsung phones. All other Qi-enabled smartphones get 5W of charging, as per the Belkin website, which is a tad disappointing. We tested the charger out with the



Samsung Galaxy S20 Ultra. The wireless charger managed to top the phone off to a 100 per cent from almost empty in about 3 hours and 50 minutes, which meets expectations. The charger feels quite robust and comes equipped

with rubberised stabilisers at the bottom to prevent the charger from getting knocked over surfaces or moved easily. It also comes with a silicone ring on top of the wireless charging pad that grips onto a phone's surface and prevents it from sliding off as well. There's an LED light that glows white when a device is successfully charging. The light turns amber in the presence of a foreign object such as keys that may disrupt your charge or even damage your belongings. The charger is compatible with all lightweight plastic cases up to 3mm in thickness, which means you won't have to remove your case every time you want to plonk your phone onto the charging pad. Additionally, you also get a 2-year warranty for extra peace of mind.

PRICE - ₹3,499



Bear Grylls Survival MASTER Series - 3749

Born out of the collaboration between survival TV's top personality Bear Grylls and Swiss watch manufacturer Luminox, the Bear Grylls Survival MASTER Series is something every adventurer would want to take with them when venturing into the wild. The watch incorporates a wide set of features that are not only utilitarian but are also aiding the aesthetics and build quality of the device. The watch itself is 45 mm wide which makes it quite huge and reminds one of the style that Casio G-Shocks are known for. Luminox uses a carbon-forged material that they call Carbonox for the casing with the buttons and dials being made of metal alloy. The 316L stainless steel backplate has Bear Grylls' motto - "Never Give Up" emblazoned in bright orange. The watch is water resistant up to 300 meters and uses a sapphire crystal with anti-reflective coating. The case has a unidirectional rotating bezel which is also made of Carbonox and has a gas tube lume at the 12-O'clock position. There's barely any space left on the watch face as the chronograph dials take up everything. The watch face also has several tritium gas tube illuminators on the needles and for the hour markers. These can supposedly maintain their glow for up to 25 years in any light condition. Coming to the strap, the MASTER Series - 3749 has a bright orange coloured EPDM strap with a stainless steel buckle. The strap itself is 24 mm wide and is quite thick. On the bottom strap, there's a compass without which this wouldn't have been a true adventurer watch. The mechanism inside the watch is a RONDA 5030.D which includes a 30 min counter, 12 hour counter, ADD and SPLIT functions, and is quite durable and long lasting. Overall, the Bear Grylls Survival MASTER Series imbibes the spirit of adventure that the survival personality is well-known for.

PRICE - ₹71,022